BOOKLESSS ▯ INTERNAL

Revenue Model & Growth Plan

Pricing structure, profitability thresholds, course rollout sequence, and team economics

May 2026

OVERVIEW

What This Model Is Built On

Booklesss delivers course content for Zambian university students through Gamma (lesson notes and presentations) and a Slack workspace (community, discussion, delivery). PDFs are no longer the format for lesson notes — they remain in use for other documents only (lead magnets, invoices, quotes). Revenue comes from two sources: full member subscriptions for workspace access, and per-course guest subscriptions. The model is built around one paid tool per full member: Slack Business+. Gamma is carried as a founder/team tool, not a per-member seat — one paid full member seat unlocks five free single-channel guest slots on Slack.

Each course is structured across roughly four content channels plus shared support channels — announcements, general, and Q&A. Full members get access to everything: all course channels, all support channels, every course running on the platform. Guests are single-channel — they access one content channel at a time and are excluded from support channels. When a guest finishes a topic, they submit a request to be moved to the next channel. Students who want simultaneous access to all channels upgrade to K600 full members, which adds K202 markup per seat rather than guest revenue. The 330-slot guest pool is filled by single-course students at K360 each, producing up to K118,800/month per course at full capacity.

This document is the financial reference model. Actual performance is tracked against these projections monthly. Deviations in conversion rate, guest count, or overhead timing should be noted and the relevant phase thresholds recalculated.

PRICING

Subscription Rates

Tier	Rate	Tools carried	Access	Net to platform
Full member	K600/month	Slack Business+ seat	All channels	K202 markup (seat cost K398)
Guest	K360/month	Single-channel guest	One channel at a time — sequential progression, no support channels	K360 — no tool cost

Exchange rate: K22.10/USD (confirmed 2026-07-07). Slack Business+ is $18/user/month on monthly billing (confirmed against slack.com/pricing/businessplus), giving a real seat cost of K398 — not the K339 this model previously assumed. Lesson notes and presentations are built and delivered in Gamma rather than PDF, but Gamma is carried as a founder/team tool (see Overhead, Phase 1) rather than a per-member seat □ members read published Gamma content via a share link, same as guests. Tool cost per full member: K398 (Slack Business+ only). Guest price is set at 60% of the full member rate (K600 □ 60% = K360). Guests stay at K360 for one month, then upgrade to K600 or leave. The K202 markup (K600 - K398 seat cost) is platform revenue only □ it does not enter the guest revenue split.

> Guest channel model:
> Each course runs across roughly 4 content channels plus shared support channels (announcements, general, Q&A;). Guests access one content channel at a time and are excluded from support channels. When a guest completes a topic, they submit a request to be moved to the next channel □ the admin reassigns them within their existing guest slot. Full members get immediate access to all channels across all courses.

> **66 full members from the launch campaign □ K202 = K13,332/month fixed markup income before a single guest joins. K13,332 exceeds all five overhead phases including Phase 5 (K7,426) □ the platform is fully profitable from day 1 with zero guests.**

ACQUISITION

Campaign Math

The campaign targets full paying members. A K10,000 budget covers both flyer printing at K10 per flyer and a K50 commission paid to the campus distributor for each student who signs up and pays. At a 10% conversion rate that yields 66 full members. Their 66 seats unlock 330 single-channel guest slots across the workspace.

> **Cost per flyer: K10 print + (10% □ K50 commission) = K15 total per flyer**
>
> **K10,000 □ K15 = 666 flyers distributed**
>
> **666 □ 10% conversion = 66 full members**
>
> **66 members □ 5 guest slots = 330 guest slots unlocked**
>
> **Guest slots = single-course students only (1 slot = 1 student in 1 channel)**
>
> **330 guests □ K360 = K118,800/month guest revenue ceiling per course**
>
> **Multi-course students upgrade to K600 full member □ adds K202 markup, no slot used**

Recruiting 50 students who each take multiple courses is far easier than recruiting 200 separate people. The multi-course model lowers the acquisition target without changing the revenue ceiling.

REVENUE STRUCTURE

How Money Flows

Guest revenue moves through two stages. First, 5% comes off the top as team welfare � covering data, meals, and transport for the course team. The remaining 95% splits three ways: 20% goes directly into the marketing campaign fund, 60% goes to the course team, and 20% goes to the platform. Every rand that flows through the campaign fund buys flyers at K15 effective cost and converts to new full members at 10% � the team is funding their own growth.

> **Guest revenue**
>
> **- 5% welfare (data, meals, transport)**
>
> **= distributable revenue**
>
> **? Marketing fund 20% ? campaign (K68.40 per student)**
>
> **? Course team 60%**
>
> **? Platform 20%**
>
> **Platform total = Platform 20% of distributable + K13,332 full member markup**
>
> **Platform net = Platform total - Overhead**
>
> **Campaign total = Platform net + Marketing fund (all reinvested)**

The course team's 60% is never touched by overhead. The platform bears all fixed costs from its 20% share plus the markup. The team earns from the first guest � and the platform is already profitable before the first guest ever joins.

OVERHEAD

Cost Phases

Overhead is structured in five phases. With K13,332/month in markup from 66 full members, all five phases are active from launch � the markup alone covers Phase 5 (K7,426) before a single guest joins. No guest threshold is required to unlock any phase. All manager costs are platform overhead, never deducted from the team's share.

Phase	Trigger	New cost	Overhead
1 — Launch	Course opens	Founder Slack K398 + Founder Claude K442 + Manager Slack K398 + Founder Gamma Pro K552	K1,790
2 — Activate	Launch (day 1)	+ Manager Claude $20 (K442) — markup covers it immediately	K2,232
3 — Scale	Launch (day 1)	+ Founder Claude upgrade to $100 (+K1,768) — markup covers it immediately	K4,000
4 — Full build	Launch (day 1)	+ Manager Claude upgrade to $100 (+K1,768) — markup covers it immediately	K5,768
5 — Content scale	Launch (day 1)	+ Founder Gamma upgrade Pro to Ultra, $100 (+K1,658) — markup covers it immediately	K7,426

PROFITABILITY

Full Model by Guest Count

Table A shows what the course team earns at each guest count (60% of distributable). Table B shows what the platform earns, including the K13,332/month fixed markup from 66 full members. All five phases are profitable at zero guests — the markup alone covers Phase 5. ? marks the 0-guest row where full overhead is covered from launch.

Table A — Team Earnings (per course, per month)

> **All phases active from launch — markup K13,332 covers Phase 5 (K7,426) before any guests**

Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Team 60%
0 ?	K0	K0	K0
10	K3,600	K180	K2,052
20	K7,200	K360	K4,104
30	K10,800	K540	K6,156

> **Phase 5 — overhead K7,426 | active from launch**

Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Team 60%
30	K10,800	K540	K6,156
50	K18,000	K900	K10,260
100	K36,000	K1,800	K20,520
330 max	K118,800	K5,940	K67,716

Table B — Platform Economics (per course, per month)

All phases active from launch — profitable at 0 guests

Guests	Plat. 20%	Markup	Overhead	Net
0 ?	K0	K13,332	K7,426	+K5,906
10	K684	K13,332	K7,426	+K6,590
20	K1,368	K13,332	K7,426	+K7,274
30	K2,052	K13,332	K7,426	+K7,958

Phase 5 — overhead K7,426 | active from launch, no guest threshold

Guests	Plat. 20%	Markup	Overhead	Net
50	K3,420	K13,332	K7,426	+K9,326
100	K6,840	K13,332	K7,426	+K12,746
330 max	K22,572	K13,332	K7,426	+K28,478

? = all phases profitable from 0 guests. Net = Plat. 20% + Markup - Overhead. Plat. 20% = guests × K360 × 95% × 20% = guests × K68.40. Team 60% = guests × K342 × 60% = guests × K205.20. Marketing 20% (guests × K68.40) flows directly to campaign — not shown here.

MILESTONES

Decision Points

Each milestone marks a threshold where the platform activates the next level of tooling. With K13,332 in monthly markup from 66 full members, all five overhead phases are active from launch. No guest threshold is required to unlock any phase.

Guests	Trigger	Action
0 (launch)	Campaign complete � 66 full members	Open course. Activate all tooling through Phase 5 immediately � K13,332 markup covers all phases from day 1
330	All slots filled	K28,478 platform net, team earning K67,716 � open waitlist for next course

GROWTH ENGINE

The Reinvestment Loop

Platform net income goes straight back into the flyer campaign � no extraction, no holding. Every month, the full net is converted to flyers at K15 effective cost (K10 print + K5 commission reserve). At a steady 10% conversion rate, the loop compounds automatically.

> **K150 net income ? 10 flyers ? 1 new full member ? K202/month markup (permanent)**
>
> **Payback period: K150 � K202 = under 1 month � immediate compounding**
>
> **Each month's net becomes next month's campaign budget.**
>
> **More members ? higher markup ? larger campaign ? more members.**

At launch the net surplus is K5,906/month � it funds 393 flyers and adds roughly 39 new members. Those 39 members add K7,878/month in markup, lifting the next month's net to K13,784. The month after: K13,784 funds 918 flyers, adds 91 more members, net rises to K32,166. The campaign never stops � it just gets bigger each cycle (this is slower than the earlier version of this model, which folded a per-member Gamma seat into the markup � with Gamma removed from member pricing, the K202 markup is a leaner, more defensible number to compound from).

Month	Net into campaign	Flyers	New members	Cumul. members	Markup/month
Launch	K10,000 (seed)	666	66	66	K13,332
1	K5,906	393	39	105	K21,210
2	K13,784	918	91	196	K39,592
3	K32,166	2,144	214	410	K82,820
4	K75,394	5,026	502	912	K184,224

> Reality check: this table is an uncapped illustration of the compounding mechanic, not a forecast. It assumes every month's flyer batch converts at the same 10% rate with no limit on how many Zambian university students exist to recruit — by Month 4 it implies more members than any single university's target-course enrolment could plausibly supply. Treat this section as 'how the engine works,' and the 12-month conservative forecast below (which caps guest ramp and applies real churn) as the actual planning number.

12-Month NPV Forecast — Conservative Assumptions

This forecast is deliberately built to underestimate profit and overestimate risk. If the platform performs to these numbers, it is already doing well. Real performance is expected to exceed them.

Discount rate: 25% p.a. (BOZ policy rate 13.25% plus a conservative 12% risk premium). Full member monthly churn: 7% — above the academic-subscription norm, below the general edtech benchmark of 8–15% (loyalty.cx). Guest monthly churn: 10%. Guest upgrade rate: 2%/month. New guests recruited by course team: 5 in Month 1, growing by 3 per month — a deliberately slow ramp. Flyer conversion held at 10%. All net income reinvested into campaign each month.

Mth	FM	Guests	Team 60%	Founders	Net	PV Net	Cumul. NPV
1	66	0	K0	K0	K5,906	K5,797	K5,797
2	64	5	K1,026	K342	K5,844	K5,632	K11,429
3	63	13	K2,668	K889	K6,189	K5,853	K17,282
4	64	23	K4,720	K1,573	K7,075	K6,568	K23,850
5	68	35	K7,182	K2,394	K8,704	K7,931	K31,781
6	78	47	K9,644	K3,215	K11,545	K10,325	K42,106
7	85	61	K12,517	K4,172	K13,916	K12,218	K54,324
8	100	77	K15,800	K5,267	K18,041	K15,547	K69,871
9	124	93	K19,084	K6,361	K23,983	K20,287	K90,158
10	159	111	K22,777	K7,592	K32,284	K26,807	K116,965
11	208	130	K26,676	K8,892	K43,482	K35,438	K152,403
12	275	149	K30,575	K10,192	K58,316	K46,653	K199,056

FM = full members at start of month. Team 60% = guests × K342 × 60% = guests × K205.20. Founders = Platform 20% of distributable (guests × K68.40) — extracted as personal income. Net = Marketing 20% + FM markup - overhead — stays in business, reinvests into campaign. Overhead K7,426 from day 1 (all phases active from launch). Always net positive — floor K5,844 in Month 2. Per founder: divide Founders column by 3. PV at 25% p.a. — DF = 1/(1.25)^(n/12). 12m undiscounted net: K235,285. NPV:

K199,056.

> Conservative 12-month NPV at 25% p.a.: K199,056
> Undiscounted net over 12 months: K235,285
> Month 12: 275 FM, 149 guests, K58,316 net/month
> Always net positive ▯ floor K5,844 in Month 2.
> Higher churn, slower growth, 25% discount ▯ real performance should exceed this floor.

> **HOW MUCH BOOKLESSS GROWS ▯ 12 months at K600 / K360 pricing**
>
> **Full members: 66 ? 275 +317%**
>
> **Monthly net income: K5,906 ? K58,316 +887%**
>
> **Course team income: K0 ? K30,575/month**
>
> **Each founder's share: K0 ? K3,397/month (Founders column ▯ 3)**
>
> **Year 1 cumulative net retained in business: K235,285**
>
> **Year 1 NPV (25% discount rate): K199,056**
>
> **These are the conservative numbers ▯ 7% member churn, slow guest ramp,**
>
> **10% flyer conversion. Real growth should be faster.**

> **The campaign is never a one-time spend. It is a permanent engine: net income in ? flyers out ? members in ? more net ? repeat. The K10,000 seed starts the loop. After that, the platform funds its own growth.**

ROLLOUT

Course Launch Sequence

No course opens without at least one confirmed guest commitment ▯ this confirms real demand before hiring a manager. The threshold is low because the K13,332 markup already covers all overhead through Phase 5 from launch, including all four courses.

Course	Min. guests	Why
Course 1	1 committed	K13,332 markup > K1,790 overhead ▯ profitable immediately
Course 2	1 committed	K13,332 > K2,188 (adds K398 manager Slack seat) ▯ still covered by markup
Course 3	1 committed	K13,332 > K2,586 (adds another K398) ▯ still covered
Course 4	1 committed	K13,332 > K2,984 (adds third K398) ▯ covered by markup, no guests required

> Rollout sequence:
> Campaign ? 66 full members (330 guest slots unlocked)
> ? Waitlist opens for Course 1
> ? 1 guest committed ? Course 1 launches, manager hired
> ? Waitlist opens for Course 2
> ? 1 guest committed ? Course 2 launches, manager hired
> ? Repeat for Courses 3 and 4
>
> At four courses running at full capacity: K118,800/month guest revenue per course.

TEAM

Course Team Structure

Each course has one matched team. The Manager handles everything for that course ⁂ content delivery, community management, and marketing. Sourcers bring in source material and student referrals. Manager and Sourcers apply for a specific course and are matched before launch. No person crosses courses.

> **Course team: 60% of distributable guest revenue (Manager 36% + Sourcers 24%)**
>
> **Marketing fund: 20% of distributable guest revenue ? campaign**
>
> **Welfare: 5% of gross guest revenue (data, meals, transport ⁂ off the top)**
>
> **At 330 guests max: Course team K67,716 + Welfare K5,940 = K73,656 to team**

Welfare is not a fixed amount ⁂ it grows with the course. At 10 guests the pool is K180. At 200 guests it is K3,600. Data stays covered throughout. Meals and transport become meaningful as the course matures and in-person sessions become regular.

> **All platform overhead ⁂ founder Slack, founder Claude, manager Slack seat, manager Claude ⁂ is borne by the platform from its 20% share and the full member markup. The course team's 60% is never reduced by overhead at any stage.**

PAYMENT CADENCE

Weekly Team Payouts

Students pay monthly. The team gets paid weekly. Each student payment received during the week is split immediately and batched into a single Friday mobile money transfer to the Manager and Sourcers. No waiting until month-end.

> **Per student payment received:**
>
> **K360 □ 5% = K18.00 welfare (team data/meals/transport pool)**
>
> **K360 □ 95% = K342.00 distributable**
>
> **? Marketing 20% = K68.40 (straight to campaign fund)**
>
> **? Course team 60% = K205.20 (Manager + Sourcers)**
>
> **? Platform 20% = K68.40 (retained by platform)**

Weekly Payout by Batch Size

If N students pay in the same week, multiply by N. Payments trickle across the month □ some weeks are heavier than others. Pay what came in that week. Do not hold.

Guests paid	Gross	Welfare	Marketing	Team 60%	Platform
1	K360	K18.00	K68.40	K205.20	K68.40
5	K1,800	K90.00	K342.00	K1,026.00	K342.00
10	K3,600	K180.00	K684.00	K2,052.00	K684.00
20	K7,200	K360.00	K1,368.00	K4,104.00	K1,368.00
50	K18,000	K900.00	K3,420.00	K10,260.00	K3,420.00

Full member markup (K13,332/month from 66 members) goes entirely to the platform and is not distributed weekly to the team. Transfer it to the platform account once per month as members pay their subscriptions.

> How to run it each Friday:
> 1. Open your payment log (WhatsApp thread or spreadsheet)
> 2. Sum all guest payments received Monday□Friday
> 3. Apply the formula: Gross □ 95% □ 60% ? Course team
> 4. Transfer via Airtel/MTN Mobile Money □ same day
> 5. Log: 'Week ending [date] □ [N] payments □ Manager K[X] sent ?'
>
> Keep every transfer receipt. This is the record actual performance is measured against.

> **Weekly payments are motivating and low-risk. You only pay money already received □ there is no float or advance. If a student is late paying, that week's batch is simply smaller. The formula never changes.**